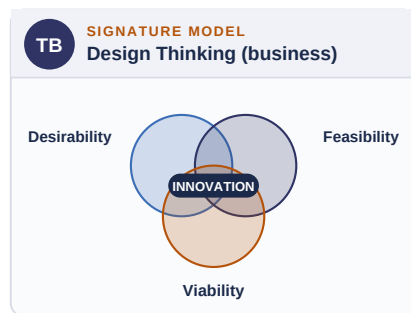


Tim Brown

Design Thinking as Innovation Strategy

b. 1962 · Former CEO & Chair, IDEO · author of *Change by Design*



"Design thinking is a human-centered approach to innovation."

"Fail early to succeed sooner."

1 WHY THIS THINKER MATTERS

Brown took design thinking out of the studio and into the C-suite. He is the reason executives talk about 'design thinking' at all — reframing it from styling products to a human-centred strategy for innovation balancing desirability, feasibility and viability.

2 INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

British industrial designer and former CEO of the global design consultancy IDEO. Through his writing and his 2009 *Harvard Business Review* work, he articulated design thinking as a discipline for business innovation, not just product aesthetics.

3 FRAMEWORKS · TOOLS · MODELS

NAME	WHAT IT IS
Design Thinking (business)	Human-centred, integrative approach to innovation
Desirability–Feasibility–Viability	The three overlapping lenses of innovation
Empathy-led innovation	Start from human needs, then technology and business
Prototyping to think	Build to learn; bias toward action
Divergence–convergence	Expand options before narrowing to solutions

4 HOW IT'S OPERATIONALIZED

- Start innovation from observed human needs, not technology
- Test concepts against all three lenses before committing
- Prototype early and cheaply to think through making
- Build multidisciplinary teams around the problem
- Balance analytical and intuitive thinking

5 LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUES

- Design thinking later criticised as over-hyped or diluted
- Risk of process theatre without genuine culture change
- Practitioner framing, light on controlled evidence
- Can underplay implementation and organisational politics
- 'Innovation' claims sometimes outrun measured results

6 ENDURING IMPACT

- Put design thinking on the executive agenda worldwide
- *Change by Design* a foundational popular text
- IDEO's methods embedded across industries and education
- Shaped how business schools teach innovation
- Direct anchor for BCOBM126 Units 3 and 5

SELECTED WORKS

CHANGE BY DESIGN <i>How Design Thinking Transforms Organizations</i> BROWN · 2009	DESIGN THINKING <i>Harvard Business Review</i> BROWN · 2008	CHANGE BY DESIGN (REVISED) <i>Harper Business</i> BROWN · 2019	THE MAKING OF A DESIGN THINKER <i>essays</i> BROWN · 2010s
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REFERENCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

- Brown, T. (2009) *Change by Design*. New York: Harper Business.
- Brown, T. (2008) 'Design Thinking', *Harvard Business Review*, 86(6), pp. 84–92.